# Has Clean Cooking Kept Pace?

*SDG 7 - Affordable and Clean Energy*

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# Research Question



**Since 2015, electricity access has expanded rapidly across the developing world. Has clean cooking kept pace — and where is the gap widest and still growing?**

# SDG 7: Affordable and Clean Energy

**7.1.1 Access to electricity**

**7.1.2 Reliance on clean cooking fuels**

**Cooking gap = electricity access % - clean cooking %**

**measured in percentage points (pp)**

A country at 97% electricity and 10% clean cooking has a gap of 87 pp. The measure asks whether the two forms of energy access arrived together.

# Where the Data Comes From

Data retrieved from

***UN SDG Global Indicators Database (UN Statistics Division)***

via API v5

***Underlying Sources:***

1. World Bank (7.1.1)
2. WHO (7.1.2)
3. UN SD/IEA Energy Balances (7.2.1, 7.3.1)

**UN SDG API v5**

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**2015-2024**

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**228 countries**

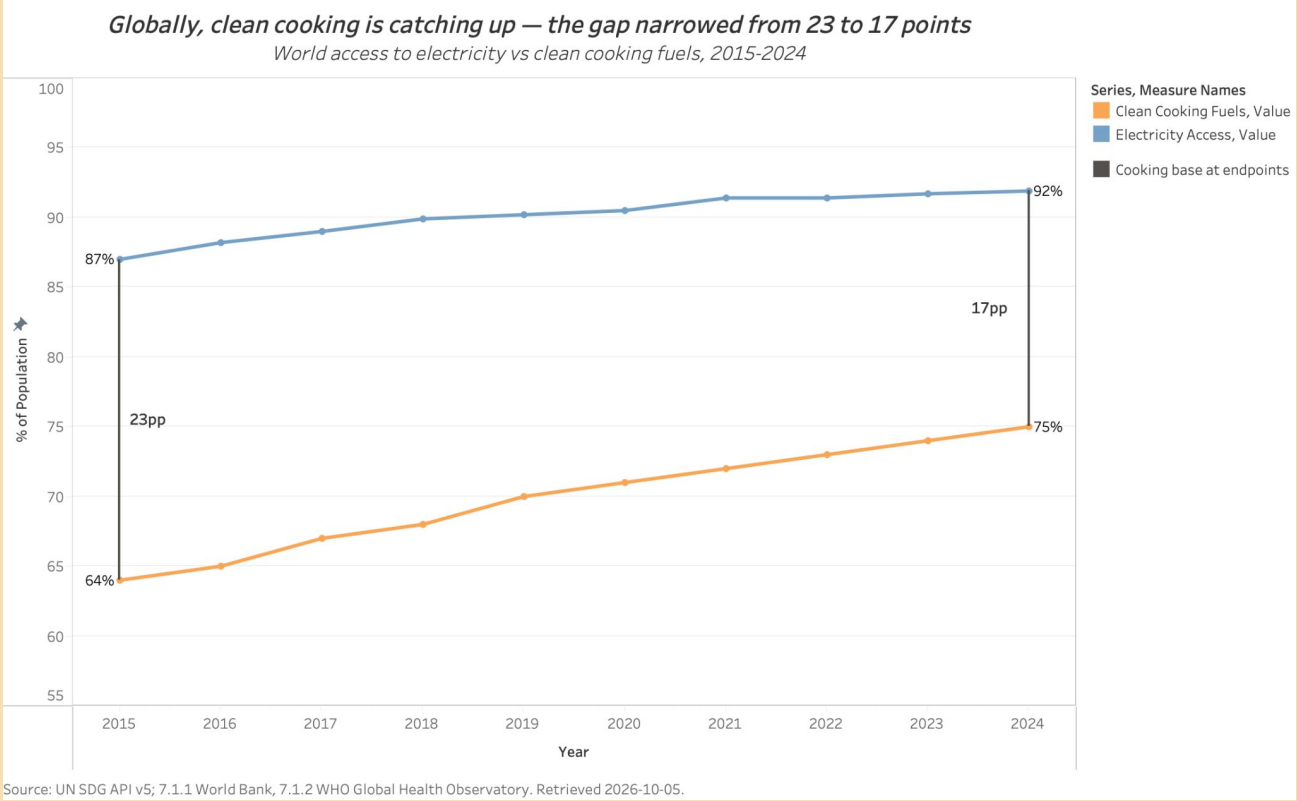
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**16,216 rows after cleaning**

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**Python → Excel →Tableau**

# Finding 1 Of 5




Source: UN SDG API v5; 7.1.1 World Bank, 7.1.2 WHO Global Health Observatory. Retrieved 2026-10-05.

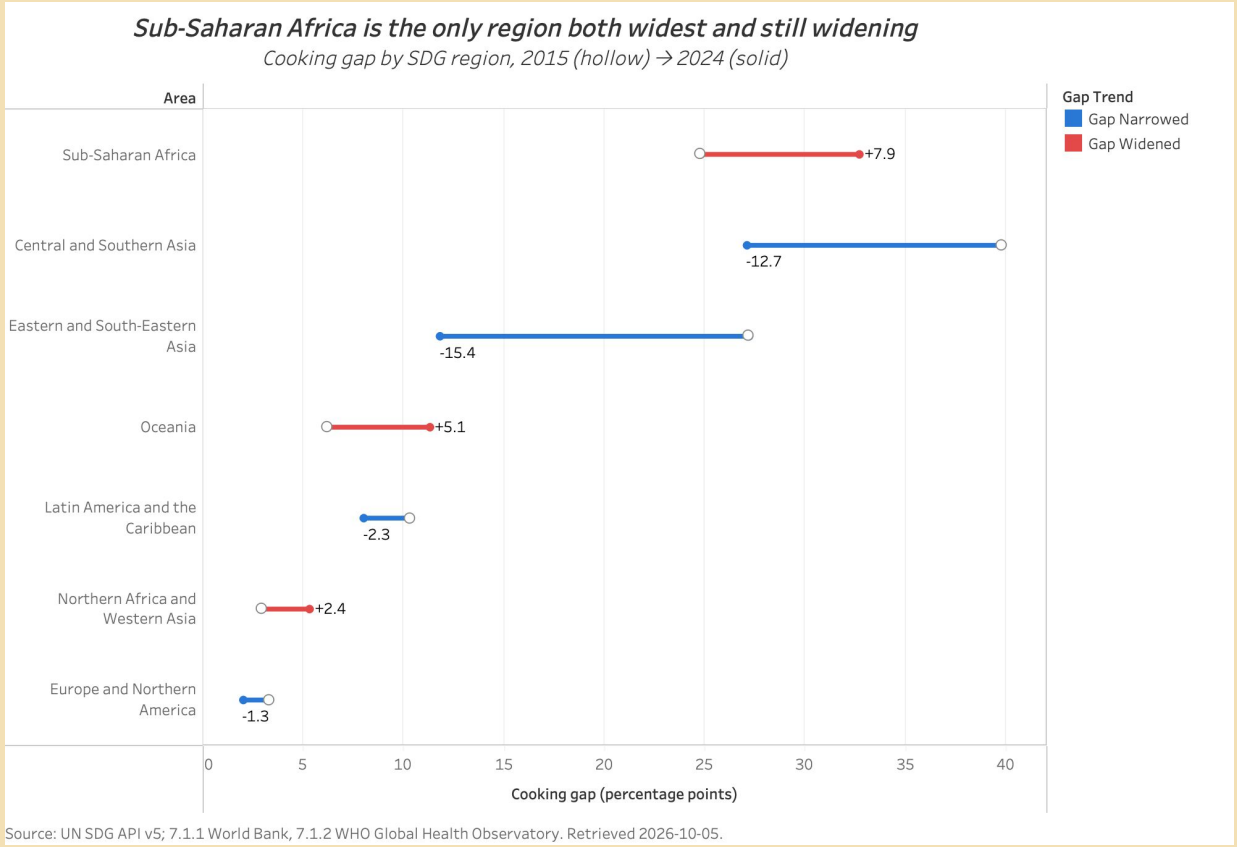
**+11 pp**

clean cooking, 2015 → 2024

against +4.9 pp for electricity

The gap narrowed from 23 to 17 points. Electricity looks slow only because richer regions already sit near 100%.

# Finding 2 Of 5




Source: UN SDG API v5; 7.1.1 World Bank, 7.1.2 WHO Global Health Observatory. Retrieved 2026-10-05.

**32.7 pp**

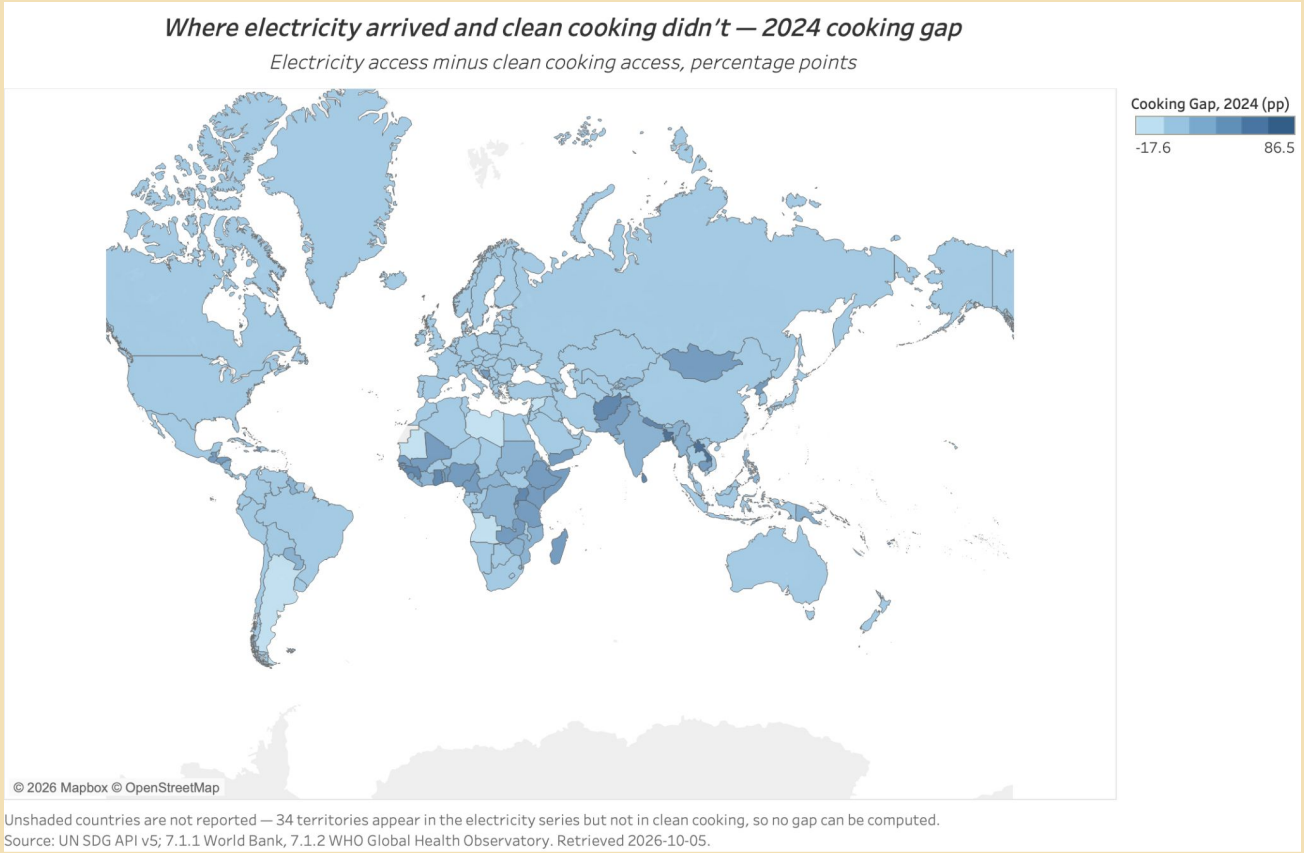
Sub-Saharan Africa, 2024

up 7.9 points since 2015

Four regions narrowed their gap. Three widened.

Sub-Saharan Africa is the only region that is both the widest and still widening — moving against the global trend.

# Finding 3 Of 5




Unshaded countries are not reported — 34 territories appear in the electricity series but not in clean cooking, so no gap can be computed.
Source: UN SDG API v5; 7.1.1 World Bank, 7.1.2 WHO Global Health Observatory. Retrieved 2026-10-05.

**86.5 pp**

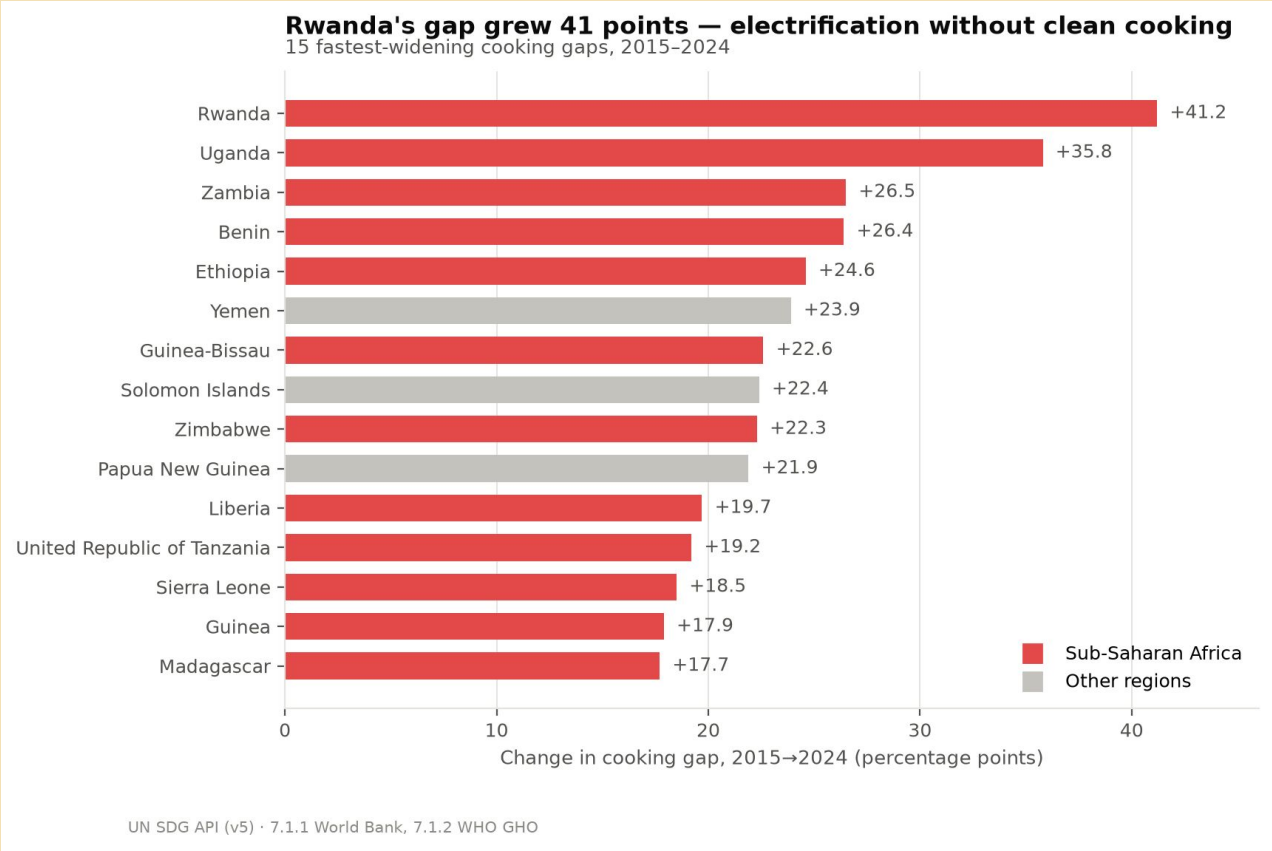
Lao PDR — the widest gap

in the dataset

97% of people have electricity. 10% cook with clean fuels.

Comoros follows at 80.7 and Timor-Leste at 75.3. The widest gaps cluster in Asia and the Pacific.

# Finding 4 Of 5




**3 of 15**

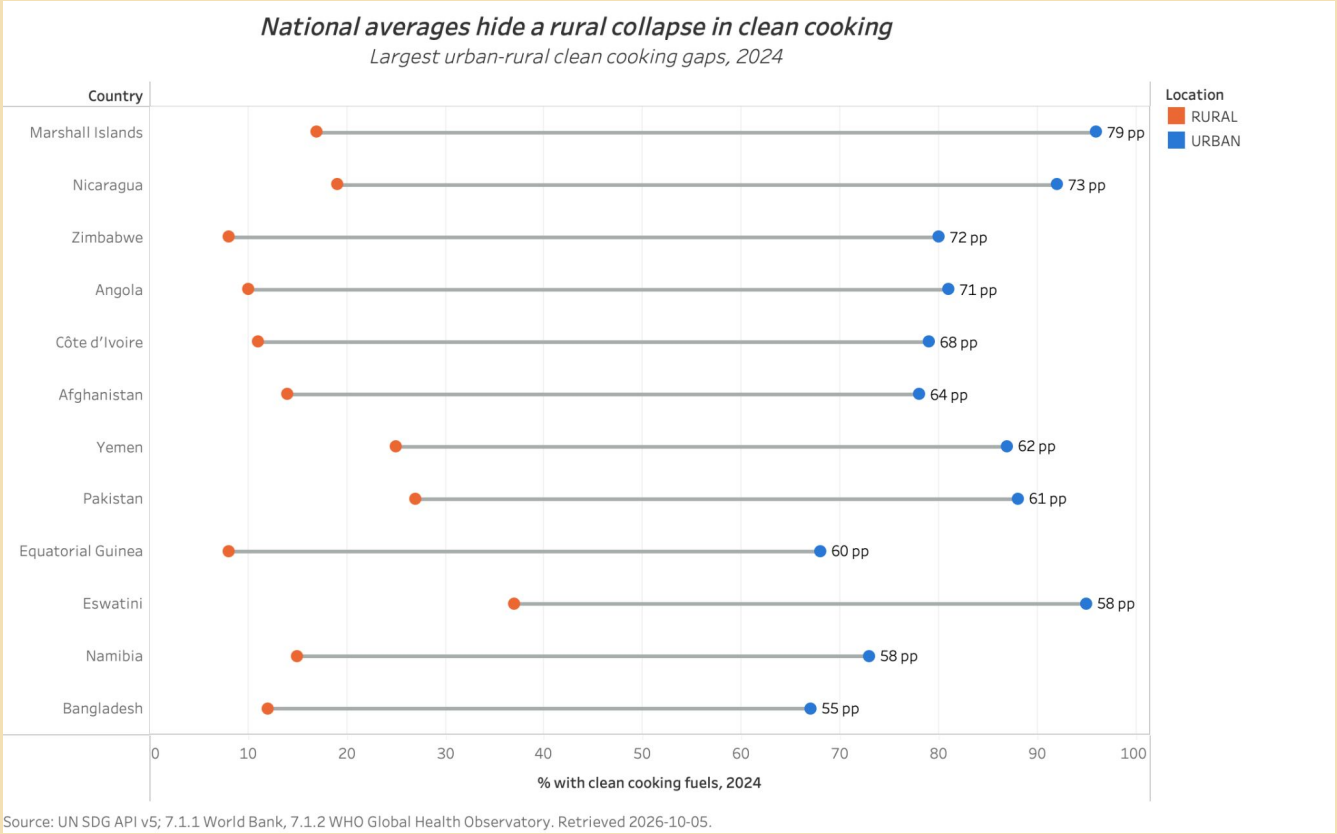
countries appear on both the

widest and widening lists

Rwanda's gap grew 41 points in nine years. Twelve of the fifteen fastest-widening countries are in Sub-Saharan Africa.

Asking only "where is it widest?" would have produced a presentation about Laos.

# Finding 5 Of 5




Source: UN SDG API v5; 7.1.1 World Bank, 7.1.2 WHO Global Health Observatory. Retrieved 2026-10-05.

**80 / 8**

Zimbabwe, 2024 — percent of urban and rural households

Zimbabwe reports 37% nationally, which looks unremarkable in a ranking.

The deficit lives inside countries, not only between them.